

Soul: Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation

SIX SURVIVAL TERMS → WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS → PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH → KARMA, REBIRTH AND BUDDHIST → LIBERATION PARITY BENCH → VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 SIX SURVIVAL TERMS

SIX SURVIVAL TERMS ALLEGED ENDURING SUBJECT PERSONAL IDENTITY WHAT MAKES LATER PERSON SAME SURVIVAL OF DEATH NEW EMBODIED EXISTENCE DIVINE RESTORATION OF EMBODIED PERSON RELEASE FROM BONDAGE

SOUL = alleged enduring subject

PERSONAL IDENTITY = what makes later person same

IMMORTALITY = survival of death

REBIRTH = new embodied existence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SOUL = alleged enduring subject
- PERSONAL IDENTITY = what makes later person same
- IMMORTALITY = survival of death

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REBIRTH = new embodied existence
- RESURRECTION = divine restoration of embodied person
- LIBERATION = release from bondage

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUESTIONS MUST BE KEPT DISTINCT what survives? → by what continuity criterion? → where/when? → through whose agency?
- is survival endless life, renewed embodiment, or freedom from rebirth?
- TERM CONTROL prevents treating Plato, Buddhism, Vedānta and Christianity as one doctrine.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Immortality means the soul's survival after bodily death, rebirth means karmically conditioned re-becoming, and liberation means release from the cycle of birth and death.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Immortality means the soul's survival after bodily death, rebirth means karmically conditioned re-becoming, and liberation means release from the cycle of birth and death.

01

STAGE 01 WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS

WESTERN IMMORTALITY ARGUMENTS PLATO CYCLICAL ARGUMENT OPPOSITES ARISE FROM OPPOSITES RECOLLECTION A PRIORI KNOWLEDGE SUGGESTS PRENATAL EXISTENCE AFFINITY INVISIBLE RATIONAL SOUL RESEMBLES UNCHANGING FORMS PHAEDO FINAL ARGUMENT

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- PLATO cyclical argument: opposites arise from opposites recollection: a priori knowledge suggests prenatal existence affinity: invisible rational soul
- resembles unchanging Forms
- Phaedo final argument: soul essentially bears life and cannot admit death objections: pre-existence != endless survival

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- harmony analogy
- dependence on brain
- DESIRE/JUSTICE ARGUMENTS: fulfillment or moral completion suggests afterlife limit: wish and moral need do not by themselves establish

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- metaphysical survival.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Immortality is the continued existence of the soul after bodily death.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Immortality is the continued existence of the soul after bodily death.

02

STAGE 02 PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH

PERSONAL IDENTITY AFTER DEATH IDENTITY CANDIDATES SAME IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE BODILY CONTINUITY MEMORY AND PSYCHOLOGICAL CONTINUITY (LOCKE) CAUSAL NARRATIVE CONTINUITY BRAVE OFFICER EXPOSES MEMORY TRANSITIVITY PROBLEM DUPLICATION

same immaterial substance

bodily continuity / resurrection

memory and psychological continuity (Locke)

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTITY CANDIDATES
- same immaterial substance
- bodily continuity / resurrection

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- memory and psychological continuity (Locke)
- causal narrative continuity
- REID: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict
- sameness or survival-grade continuity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — REID: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict sameness or survival-grade continuity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: brave officer exposes memory transitivity problem duplication: one psychology copied twice cannot yield two numerically identical persons resurrection requires divine re-identification of this person, not mere replica production verdict depends on whether identity needs strict sameness or survival-grade continuity.

03

STAGE 03 KARMA, REBIRTH AND BUDDHIST CONTINUITY

KARMA, REBIRTH AND BUDDHIST CONTINUITY INDIAN REBIRTH KARMA + SAMSKĀRA/VĀSANĀ RENEWED EMBODIMENT IN SAMSĀRA BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN FIVE SKANDHAS + DEPENDENT ORIGINATION CAUSAL STREAM REBIRTH WITHOUT TRANSMIGRANT FLAME-TO-FLAME

NEITHER NUMERICALLY IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY UNRELATED INTENTION CONDITIONS LATER

INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṃskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṃsāra

BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant

memory is causally produced cognition objection: who receives karma?

reply: demand for substance mistakes continuity for identity nirvāna ends craving and the causal appropriation

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṃskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṃsāra
- BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant flame-to-flame: neither numerically

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- memory is causally produced cognition objection: who receives karma?
- reply: demand for substance mistakes continuity for identity nirvāna ends craving and the causal appropriation that renews birth.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- INDIAN REBIRTH: karma + saṃskāra/vāsanā → renewed embodiment in saṃsāra
- BUDDHISM DENIES ĀTMAN five skandhas + dependent origination → causal stream → rebirth without transmigrant flame-to-flame: neither numerically

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Buddhist rebirth is the causal continuation of dependently arisen aggregates without anātman (a permanent self).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Buddhist rebirth is the causal continuation of dependently arisen aggregates without anātman (a permanent self).

04

STAGE 04 LIBERATION PARITY BENCH

LIBERATION PARITY BENCH SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION ADVAITA AVIDYĀ, FALSE IDENTITY JĪĀNA VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA KARMA, DEPENDENCE OBSCURED BHAKTI/PRAPATTI; COMMUNION ŚĀMĀKHYA-YOGA PURUṢA-PRAKṚTI CONFUSION KAIVALYA THROUGH VIVEKA

NYĀYA FALSE KNOWLEDGE, DOṢA, KARMA APAVARGA

CESSATION OF PAIN

JAINISM KARMIC PUḌGALA ON JĪVA KEVALA-JĪĀNA, SIDDHAHOOD

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION

Advaita avidyā, false identity jīāna: ātman = Brahman

Viśiṣṭādvaita karma, dependence obscured bhakti/prapatti; communion

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

Sāṃkhya-Yoga puruṣa-prakṛti confusion kaivalya through viveka

Nyāya false knowledge, doṣa, karma apavarga: cessation of pain

Jainism karmic puḍgala on jīva kevala-jīāna, siddhahood

EVALUATION / TRAP

Buddhism craving/ignorance nirvāna

Christianity sin/death resurrection and salvation

SAME WORD "release" conceals different selves, causes, methods and end-states.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- SCHOOL BONDAGE LIBERATION
- Advaita avidyā, false identity jīāna: ātman = Brahman
- Viśiṣṭādvaita karma, dependence obscured bhakti/prapatti; communion

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Sāṃkhya-Yoga puruṣa-prakṛti confusion kaivalya through viveka
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EVALUATION / TRAP

- Buddhism craving/ignorance nirvāna
- Christianity sin/death resurrection and salvation
- SAME WORD "release" conceals different selves, causes, methods and end-states.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Apavarga (cessation of suffering and release), jīvanmukti (liberation while living) and kaivalya (isolation of pure consciousness) distinguish three forms of liberation; the last isolates puruṣa (pure consciousness) from prakṛti (material nature).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Apavarga (cessation of suffering and release), jīvanmukti (liberation while living) and kaivalya (isolation of pure consciousness) distinguish three forms of liberation; the last isolates puruṣa (pure consciousness) from prakṛti (material nature).

05

STAGE 05 VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES

VEDĀNTA AND JAIN ROUTES SUBTLE BODY CARRIES KARMA UNTIL KNOWLEDGE; JĪVANMUKTI POSSIBLE VIDEHAMUKTI ENDS EMBODIMENT, NOT THE ĀTMAN'S EXISTENCE JĪVA REMAINS REAL AND DISTINCT; GRACE, BHAKTI AND PRAPATTI JĪVA + PASSIONS/ACTIVITY BANDHĀ SAMVĀRA BLOCKS INFLEX

NIRJARĀ SHEDS KARMA

MOKṢA CONTRAST

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ADVAITA: subtle body carries karma until knowledge; jīvanmukti possible

videhamukti ends embodiment, not the ātman's existence

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: jīva remains real and distinct; grace, bhakti and prapatti lead to God

JAINISM: jīva + passions/activity → āśrava → bandhā samvāra blocks inflex → nirjarā sheds karma → kevala-jīāna →

EVALUATION / TRAP

Rāmānuja perfects dependence

Jainism purges material karma from an eternally individual soul.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- ADVAITA: subtle body carries karma until knowledge; jīvanmukti possible
- videhamukti ends embodiment, not the ātman's existence

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: jīva remains real and distinct; grace, bhakti and prapatti lead to God
- JAINISM: jīva + passions/activity → āśrava → bandhā samvāra blocks inflex → nirjarā sheds karma → kevala-jīāna →

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Rāmānuja perfects dependence
- Jainism purges material karma from an eternally individual soul.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Bhakti (devotion), jīāna (liberating knowledge) and karma (disciplined action) are distinct means whose relation varies by school.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Bhakti (devotion), jīāna (liberating knowledge) and karma (disciplined action) are distinct means whose relation varies by school.

06

STAGE 06 PATHS, OBJECTIONS AND ETHICAL MEANING

PATHS, OBJECTIONS AND ETHICAL MEANING THREE BROAD MEANS JĪĀNA (KNOWLEDGE) BHAKTI (DEVOTION) KARMA (DISCIPLINED ACTION) YOGA ADDS MEDITATIVE DISCIPLINE; JAINISM ADDS VOWS/AUSTERITY; BUDDHISM EIGHTFOLD DISEMBODIED SOUL LACKS INDIVIDUATION

REBIRTH LACKS MEMORY LIBERATION AS PAINLESSNESS SEEMS EMPTY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- THREE BROAD MEANS: jīāna (knowledge)
- bhakti (devotion)
- karma (disciplined action)

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- Yoga adds meditative discipline; Jainism adds vows/austerity; Buddhism eightfold path objections: disembodied soul lacks individuation
- rebirth lacks memory liberation as painlessness seems empty
- endless survival may be burden, not good replies: character/causal continuity can outlast episodic memory

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- liberation is evaluated by freedom from ignorance, craving or sin, not mere duration ethical test: doctrine should transform
- present conduct, not postpone justice to another life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — THREE BROAD MEANS: jīāna (knowledge) | bhakti (devotion) | karma (disciplined action)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Resurrection is God's reconstitution of the embodied person after one life; rebirth is repeated re-becoming; reincarnation specifically presupposes a soul re-entering flesh.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER RAIL

PYQ ANSWER RAIL DEFINE EXACT SURVIVAL TERM IDENTIFY BEARER AND CONTINUITY CRITERION EXPLAIN CAUSAL MECHANISM STATE SOTERIOLOGICAL END AND PATH STRONGEST OBJECTION (IDENTITY, EVIDENCE, JUSTICE) STRONGEST REPLY COMPARE ONE UNLIKE DOCTRINE ON SAME AXES

DEFINE exact survival term — identify bearer and continuity criterion

explain causal mechanism — state soteriological end and path

strongest objection (identity, evidence, justice) — strongest reply

compare one unlike doctrine on same axes — qualified conclusion

ANSWER AXES: self/no-self

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- DEFINE exact survival term — identify bearer and continuity criterion
- explain causal mechanism — state soteriological end and path
- strongest objection (identity, evidence, justice) — strongest reply

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- compare one unlike doctrine on same axes — qualified conclusion
- ANSWER AXES: self/no-self
- continuity/identity endless existence/release from existence

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- CLOSE: survival doctrines are credible only when their ontology of the person, continuity mechanism and ethical-liberative purpose support
- one another.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CLOSE: survival doctrines are credible only when their ontology of the person, continuity mechanism and ethical-liberative purpose support one another.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: compare one unlike doctrine on same axes — qualified conclusion.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — (OPTIONAL ADVANCED) THESE REFINEMENTS STRENGTHEN A 15/20-MARKER BUT MUST REMAIN SUBORDINATE TELEPORTATION, BRAIN-SPLIT CASES AND FRINGE REINCARNATION LITERATURE ARE DELIBERATELY THE SIX SURVIVAL-TERMS AND THE NECESSITY QUESTION LAYER 3 IS IMMORTALITY OF A SUBSTANTIAL SOUL NECESSARY FOR REBIRTH? IN THE SUBSTANTIALIST SYSTEMS (VEDĀNTA, NYĀYA, JAINISM) AN ETERNAL BUT BUDDHISM SECURES RE-BECOMING THROUGH A CAUSAL STREAM ALONE

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — (OPTIONAL ADVANCED)
- These refinements strengthen a 15/20-marker but must remain subordinate to the owner doctrines.
- Teleportation, brain-split cases and fringe reincarnation literature are deliberately excluded as low-return.
- The Six Survival-Terms and the Necessity Question LAYER 3 - ADVANCED The necessity question is a modal question, so answer it with modal vocabulary.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ANALYSIS: is immortality of a substantial soul NECESSARY for rebirth?
- In the substantialist systems (Vedānta, Nyāya, Jainism) an eternal ātman or jīva is exactly what transmigrates, so there immortality is presupposed.
- But Buddhism secures re-becoming through a causal stream alone.
- So a persisting soul is SUFFICIENT for rebirth, not NECESSARY -- Buddhism is the decisive counter-case.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ANALYSIS: is rebirth necessary for liberation?
- Liberation is defined as exit from the cycle, so it presupposes bondage-across-lives and something that is freed.
- WRONG: Treating the one-screen map as one school's doctrine.
- It is a comparative scaffold; each cell must be cashed out in that school's own terms.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.